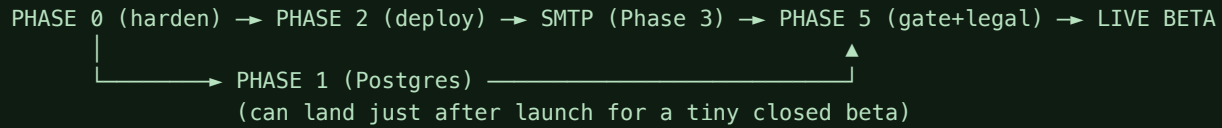


Beta Launch Roadmap

The sequenced plan behind the checklist.

Updated 2026-06-26 · SoilConnect

The path to a live URL (critical path)



Phase 4 (monitoring) runs in parallel — wire it once a host exists.

Phase 0 — Code hardening DONE

~1 session · mostly Claude · Goal: the code is safe to expose to strangers.

- **Verification toggle** — auto-verify new users when no SMTP, so testers aren't locked out.
- **Password reset** — forgot → token link → reset; returns link in no-SMTP beta.
- **Rate limiting** — per-IP limiter on auth + posts.
- **CORS lock** — allowed origin from env; body-size cap.
- **.env.example** — every knob documented; server auto-loads .env.

Phase 1 — Production data layer

~1 session · You decide, then Claude · Goal: data survives concurrent users and restarts.

- **Decision point:** JSON file is fine for a 5–10 person invite beta. Beyond that, Postgres.
- If Postgres: schema + one-time migration from data.json; same API, nothing else changes.
- Either way: a scheduled backup (file copy or pg_dump).
- *Recommendation: ship the closed beta on JSON to move fast; do the Postgres swap in parallel; cut over before widening.*

Phase 2 — Deployment

~1 session · Claude builds config, You click deploy · Goal: a URL you can text to a tester.

- Deploy config (Dockerfile + render.yaml/Procfile) and a prod build pointing the frontend at the live API.
- You create the host accounts and connect the repo (I can't provision those).
- We smoke-test the whole loop on the live URL together.

Phase 3 — Integrations

You supply keys, Claude wires · Goal: real email; geocoding that won't throttle.

- **SMTP (required for launch):** any provider (Resend, Postmark, SendGrid, Gmail SMTP). Already coded — drop-in.
- **Geocoder (optional):** Nominatim is fine for low beta traffic; add a paid key only if testers hit throttling.
- **Stripe:** skip for now — beta is free; billing stays hidden.

Phase 4 — Observability

~½ session · Claude + You for the Sentry key · Goal: you find out about bugs before testers complain.

- Error monitoring (Sentry free tier), server logging, a health/uptime ping.

Phase 5 — Beta ops & legal

~½ session · Claude drafts, You approve · Goal: controlled, lawful, friendly beta.

- Invite-code/allowlist gating so signups stay intentional.
- In-app feedback link.
- Basic Privacy Policy + Terms (you're collecting emails — these are needed).
- A short tester welcome guide.

Suggested order of operations

1. Now: Phase 0 items (all code, no waiting on you). — **DONE**
2. Next: Phase 2 deploy config + Phase 5 drafts (legal/welcome) so they're ready.
3. When you have an SMTP login + host accounts: wire SMTP, deploy, smoke-test → closed beta is live.
4. In parallel / right after: Phase 1 Postgres swap + Phase 4 monitoring before widening.